GitHub Pages Deployment Guide

Step-by-step instructions to deploy portfolio updates by recreating the `gh-pages` branch using `git subtree`.

Prerequisite: Check Terminal Location

Ensure your terminal is in your root project folder (ending in `Portfolio`), not inside `src`.

```
cd ..  # Run this if your terminal path ends in \src
```

Step 1: Save & Push Latest Changes to Main

Stage, commit, and push all your updated code and assets to your `main` branch.

```
git add .
git commit -m "Update portfolio files and assets"
git push origin main
```

Step 2: Delete Old Remote gh-pages Branch

Delete the remote `gh-pages` branch on GitHub so we can perform a completely clean deployment.

```
git push origin --delete gh-pages
```

Step 3: Flatten & Push `src` Folder as Root

Run the `subtree` command to extract the contents of the `src` folder (making `index.html` the root file) and push it directly to a brand new `gh-pages` branch:

```
git subtree push --prefix src origin gh-pages
```

Crucial Reminders & Troubleshooting Tips

- **Wait for GitHub Actions Build:** Even after the terminal command finishes, GitHub requires **1 to 3 minutes** to re-compile your site. Go to your repository's *Actions* tab and ensure the yellow building icon turns into a green checkmark before checking the site.
- **Bypass Browser Cache:** Browsers aggressively store old versions of static sites. Always test your live URL in an **Incognito Window** (`Ctrl + Shift + N`) or perform a hard refresh using **`Ctrl + F5`** (or `Ctrl + Shift + R`).
- **Relative Asset Paths:** Ensure all links in your HTML (images, PDFs, styles) use relative paths (e.g., `assets/reports/...` instead of `/assets/reports/...`) so GitHub Pages routes them correctly from the branch root.